

A full QA pass across all 135 test cases surfaced 29 failures, prioritized and triaged by severity. **25 are fixed and confirmed working** — verified by re-running the original failing scenarios against a live server with a real logged-in account, not just a clean build. 2 more are partially mitigated but need someone with Supabase admin access to fully close. 2 are deliberately held for a product/design call rather than a guess.

29 FAILURES FOUND	25 FIXED & VERIFIED	2 NEEDS ADMIN ACCESS	2 AWAITING A DECISION
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Security 5 OF 5 FIXED

- MSG-03

Closed a real privacy gap in direct messages
Any signed-in user could send a message into a private conversation they weren't part of — the send endpoint was missing the membership check the read endpoint already had. This was the single highest-severity finding of the whole QA pass. Now blocked with the same check used for reading.
- SEC-06

Stopped internal error details from leaking to users
Several endpoints were returning raw database error text to the client. Replaced with one shared error handler across the app: real errors are logged for us, users see a clean message.
- SEC-07/08

Hardened session handling
A corrupted login cookie could crash a request instead of just logging the user out. Session cookies are also now locked down (not readable by page JavaScript, secure-only in production).

Fixed & verified 20 ITEMS

- Content

Profanity filter now behaves consistently everywhere
A common profane word was slipping through in comments while correctly blocked in posts. The filter now matches deterministically in both places.
- Reliability

Fixed three separate 500-error crashes
Uploading a non-image file, using a search term with a "%" in it, and loading the feed while logged out all used to crash with a server error. All three now fail cleanly (or, in the logged-out feed's case, now work correctly instead of failing).

Validation	Closed client-only validation gaps Posts with no category and reports with no reason were silently accepted because the checks only existed in the UI, not the server. Both are now enforced server-side, along with a guard against reporting the same post repeatedly.
UX	Fixed a stuck "Posting..." state on a dropped connection Submitting a post while offline could leave the compose button stuck forever. It now shows a clear error and resets.
Live feed	New posts now appear without a refresh The feed had no live-update subscription despite the app advertising real-time updates elsewhere (direct messages already had this). It's now wired up the same way.
Accessibility	Keyboard and screen-reader support for the feed and comments Like/comment/delete/report controls were unreachable by keyboard. The comments panel wasn't announced as a dialog and didn't close on Escape. Both are fixed; five of six accessibility findings are resolved.

Needs your help BLOCKED ON ACCESS

PERF-04	Duplicate posts from a double-submit — partially fixed Added a server-side check that catches the common case (a retry or double-click). Re-testing the exact original bug (two truly simultaneous requests) still slipped through — closing that fully needs a uniqueness rule added directly in the database, which requires Supabase admin access I don't have from here.
NEW-02	Orphaned images after a post is deleted — partially fixed The delete code correctly targets the right file, but the storage service is silently refusing to remove it — almost certainly a missing permission rule on the file storage bucket, not a code bug. Needs about two minutes in the Supabase dashboard to add.

THE ASK

Both of these have a known, specific fix — a database constraint and a storage permission rule. I can write the exact change for whoever holds Supabase admin/service-role access to apply; the code side is already in place and waiting on it.

Awaiting a decision PRODUCT / DESIGN CALL

RT-04	Should new posts appear instantly, before the server confirms? Current behavior (wait for confirmation) is safe and correct, just not as snappy. Making it instant is a real feature, not a bug fix — held for a product call rather than guessed at.
A11Y-03	Color contrast pass needed on the feed and comments panel An automated accessibility scan flagged low-contrast text in 34 places. Fixing this blind risks trading one contrast failure for another — needs a fresh scan against the live pages before touching any colors.

Neither of these is a defect left unfixed by mistake — both are flagged in the original QA report as calls for product/design, not engineering.

Full technical detail: `Howler_QA_Fixes_Applied.xlsx`

Verified against a live server + real account, 2026-07-26 · build and lint clean